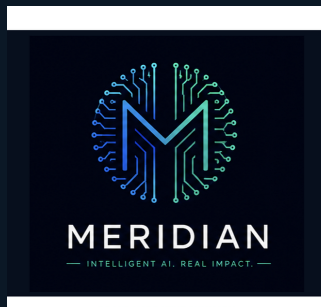




Children

Thought-Leader and Validator Map

Who to consider approaching, and in what order
Private and Confidential

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL | APPROACH SHANE-LED

STRATEGY IN ONE LINE

Two tracks. The **faith route** is a two-step: earn intellectual credibility with an independent Catholic authority (Zollner) first, then take the formal institutional door (Verny / the Pontifical Commission). In parallel, secure **secular validators** whose endorsement confers global legitimacy (Kidron, Cordua, Maalla M'jid).

Governance: identifying who to approach is intelligence work and fine to hold. Any actual approach, or any sharing of the Children architecture, is Shane-led. The Vatican-facing steps in particular are Shane's call.

1 FAITH-ALIGNED / CATHOLIC SAFEGUARDING (the Holy See bridge)

Fr Hans Zollner SJ — best faith-world bridge

Director, Institute of Anthropology, Pontifical Gregorian University; former member of the Pontifical Commission for the Protection of Minors (resigned 2023). The most internationally recognised Catholic safeguarding authority, credible inside the Holy See yet visibly independent. Engage first: his consideration earns respect and opens the route without appearing captured.

Archbishop Thibault Verny — the formal Vatican door

President of the Pontifical Commission for the Protection of Minors (appointed 2025, succeeding Cardinal O'Malley). The correct official interlocutor; approach after Zollner, for institutional standing.

2 CHILD ONLINE SAFETY AND DIGITAL RIGHTS

- **Baroness Beeban Kidron** (5Rights Foundation) — pre-eminent voice on children's rights by design; natural conceptual ally.
- **Dame Rachel de Souza** (Children's Commissioner for England) — statutory independent voice, active on AI and online harms.
- **Iain Drennan** (WeProtect Global Alliance) — best multi-stakeholder convening door.

- **Julie Inman Grant** (eSafety Commissioner, Australia) — world’s leading online-safety regulator. Handle with care: geopolitically contested by US platforms.

3 CHILD PROTECTION NGOs AND TECHNOLOGY

- **Julie Cordua** (CEO, Thorn) — the most credible child-safety-technology leader; strongest fit for a technical architecture and the safety-by-design framing.
- **Kerry Smith** (CEO, Internet Watch Foundation) — technically credible, UK-anchored, globally respected.
- **Chris Sherwood** (Chief Executive, NSPCC) — pre-eminent UK child-protection charity.
- **Michelle DeLaune** (President & CEO, NCMEC) — deep operational credibility across law enforcement and industry (US anchor).

4 AI ETHICS AND GLOBAL INSTITUTIONS

- **Dr Najat Maalla M’jid** (UN Special Representative on Violence Against Children) — already championing “protection by design”; ideal independent global endorser.
- **Gaia Marcus** (Director, Ada Lovelace Institute) — independent, non-partisan AI-governance credibility for the governed-AI and data-restraint pillars.
- **UNICEF** (Policy Guidance on AI for Children) and **UNESCO** (Gabriela Ramos, AI ethics) — strong normative weight; confirm current leads before approach.

HANDLE WITH CARE (high reach, specific risk)

Julie Inman Grant (regulator, geopolitically contested), Frances Haugen (adversarial whistleblower brand), Jonathan Haidt (contested thesis), Tristan Harris (drifting toward general AI risk). Use deliberately, not by default.

PRIORITISED SHORTLIST

#	Name	Why prioritise
1	Fr Hans Zollner SJ	Best faith-world bridge; priority one for the Holy See path
2	Baroness Beeban Kidron	Unmatched authority on child rights by design
3	Julie Cordua (Thorn)	Most credible child-safety-technology leader; best technical fit
4	Dr Najat Maalla M’jid	UN “protection by design” mandate-holder; ideal global endorser
5	Dame Rachel de Souza	Statutory independent voice, engaged on AI and children
6	Iain Drennan (WeProtect)	Best multi-stakeholder convening door
7	Kerry Smith (IWF)	Technically credible, likely open to credible partners
8	Gaia Marcus (Ada Lovelace)	Independent AI-governance credibility
9	Archbishop Thibault Verny	Formal Vatican door, after Zollner
10	Michelle DeLaune (NCMEC)	US operational credibility

Meridian Intelligence · Children thought-leader and validator map · Real, role-verified names · 25 July 2026 · Private and confidential. Approach and sharing Shane-led.